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Life Community School, BEAC03

Male Expressive Reading U16

The Calming of the Storm

In the times of the New Testament, Jesus was preaching to a massive multitude. The sun blazed through the cloud cover and the breeze swept through the sandy coast of the Sea of Galilee. The crowd became so big that Jesus had to preach from his boat! After Jesus preached about multiple parables, Jesus instructed the disciples to cross through the rugged and stormy Sea of Galilee. The disciples obeyed and they sailed away to the other side.

They sailed through the vast, open sea, slowly but surely. Down on the deck, Jesus was sleeping peacefully, however, up above, the once sunny skies slowly transitioned to a deep dark grey blanket of clouds. The clouds began to crackle like heated oil and small drops of rain began to fall. The far ocean was now nothing but fog and the winds blew like a bullet striking a target. The thunder crackled louder and louder but still, Jesus was asleep.

Soon the storm broke free and rain poured violently. The winds ripped the wooden covering off the boat and the fierce rain slowly ripped through the hardwood floors. A few minutes later the disciples clung to the pillars of the boat as the covering ripped off. Waves of water rushed in from every side and the swamping ship nearly broke apart. The disciples screamed desperate cries for help, yet Jesus still remained in his deep slumber.

Finally, the disciples screamed one last final cry, screaming, "Master, please save us!" With that cry Jesus woke up at last and saw the raging storm. To the disciples' shock, Jesus was not afraid of the storm that nearly sank the ship, instead He looked at the storm with a stern look of authority. Suddenly, he looked towards the crashing waves and said, "Quiet, be still."

Suddenly, the raging storm halted at the mere presence of his voice. The once cloudy skies turned to a shimmering blue and yellow sky. The waves and winds that were once as fierce and bold as a lion quieted down to a silent sea and a refreshing breeze. The storm had obeyed Jesus' simple command to be quiet. After the miracle Jesus bluntly asked the disciples, "Why are you so afraid? Where is your faith?" The disciples froze in awe and couldn't answer, but they knew one thing from the miracle was for sure; Jesus truly was the Son of God, and was the only human to make a storm obey His words.

Jesus performed many miracles in His lifetime, but this one about the storm teaches us to not fear, but to be courageous. As Philippians 4:13 states, "I can do all things through Christ which strengtheneth me."